

The Efficiency-First Era of Micro-SaaS & AI

1,000 startups. One story: a handful of outliers carry the index, and AI has become the default operating layer beneath them.

\$13.47M

COMBINED MRR ACROSS THE INDEX

\$282

MEDIAN STARTUP MRR

\$13,471

AVERAGE MRR — 48X THE MEDIAN

The mean is nearly 48x the median — a small set of breakout winners (Stan, GojiberryAI) skew the entire index, while a long tail sits far below \$1k MRR.

AI Is No Longer a Category — It's the Operating System

One in five startups in the index is built AI-first, and its influence runs through nearly every other category.



1

Marketing

AI replaces the tasks once outsourced to agencies — copy, attribution, outreach.

2

SaaS Tooling

AI features are now the default expectation, not a premium add-on.

3

Creative Tools

Generative workflows compress editing and content production.

Five Startups Carry an Outsized Share of the Index

Revenue concentration is extreme — the top names post 300x to 500x the median MRR.



Triple-Digit Growth Is Concentrated in Narrow Wedges

These three products found a single acute pain point and are scaling into it fast.

30-DAY MRR GROWTH

▲ 1,357%

Hidden Jobs

AI-powered job discovery

30-DAY MRR GROWTH

▲ 1,227%

HotelHero.ai

Solving hotel direct-booking

30-DAY MRR GROWTH

▲ 458%

Koe.sh

Sentence-based video editing

Marketing & Sales Is the Largest Revenue Domain — and It's Going Agentic

Autonomous agents are starting to replace the SDR function outright, not just assist it.

\$2.4M+

TOTAL SECTOR MRR

The single largest revenue domain in the index — ahead of every other category.

Research
Prospect



Message
Autonomously



Book the
Meeting

NO HUMAN IN THE LOOP

WaLead AI

Autonomous LinkedIn outbound that researches, messages, and books meetings.

MimikFlow

Agentic sales workflows built to replace manual SDR sequencing.

The Moat Isn't the AI — It's the Workflow It Replaces

Winners target high-friction, low-creativity tasks and wire themselves directly into how the work already gets done.

1Lookup

\$207K MRR

Automates tedious data validation — a task with zero creative upside but constant demand.

PROSP

\$128K MRR

Automates personalized outreach at a volume no human team could sustain manually.

“Success favors startups solving high-friction, low-creativity problems — not the flashiest AI demos.”

Profitable Founders Are Globally Distributed

The US leads, but capital-efficient hubs are emerging well outside Silicon Valley.



LEADER

United States

The largest single concentration of index founders.



ESTABLISHED

Europe

France, Germany & the UK produce a dense cluster of profitable teams.



ESTABLISHED

India

A fast-growing base of lean, revenue-first founders.



EMERGING

SE Asia & Canada

Singapore, Vietnam & Canada post high revenue on notably lower burn.

262 Startups in the Index Are Already for Sale

A ready-made acquisition pipeline exists at valuations well below typical venture entry points.

262

STARTUPS EXPLICITLY ON SALE

2.3x

MEDIAN REVENUE MULTIPLE

<1x

DEEP-VALUE LISTINGS (E.G.
LINKEDDIT)

READING THE OPPORTUNITY

Sub-1x listings like Linkeddit function as acqui-hire or quick asset flips rather than growth bets — the discount reflects limited standalone upside, not necessarily distress.

Multiples Range From Speculative to Sober

The same index holds 172x revenue asks alongside single-digit-multiple, cash-flow-backed entries.



SPECULATIVE

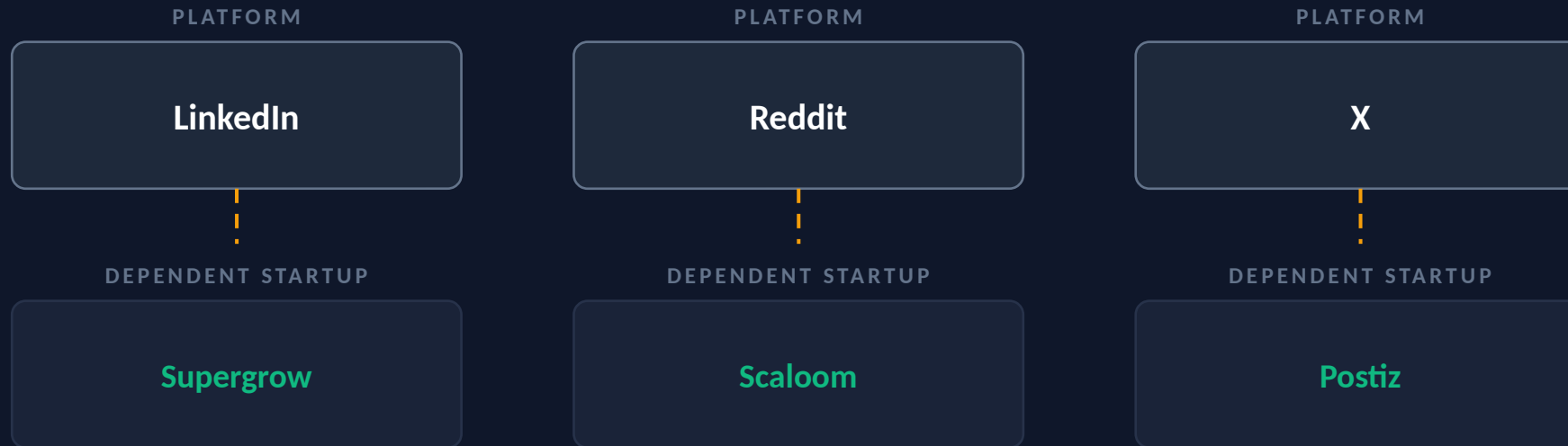
EliteGPT & Abun.com are priced at 172x revenue — pricing on a growth story, not current cash flow.

CONSERVATIVE

PROSP asks \$1M against \$128K MRR — a sustainable entry point closer to institutional norms.

The Index's Biggest Threat Isn't Competition — It's API Terms

A meaningful share of startups build entirely on top of platforms they don't control.



⚠️ INVESTOR WARNING

A single pricing or Terms-of-Service change from LinkedIn, Reddit, or X can impair revenue overnight for any startup built entirely on that API. Diligence should weight platform-risk exposure as heavily as growth rate.

Three Moves for This Market

Each targets a different part of the same efficiency thesis.

01

Consolidate the Long Tail

Acquire 3–5 sub-\$500 MRR tools in one niche (e.g. SEO) and merge into a single dominant suite.

02

Target High-Growth Efficiency

Back HotelHero.ai- and MimikFlow-type products while still in triple-digit monthly growth.

03

Arbitrage the Multiples

Buy sub-2x revenue assets and fold them into existing portfolio companies.

CONCLUSION

From “Growth at All Costs” to “Efficiency at All Costs”

Lean, AI-native teams are reaching six-figure MRR with zero traditional venture funding — the clearest signal that the human-in-the-loop is the cost this market is systematically removing.

\$100K+

MRR REACHED WITHOUT VC FUNDING

1,000

STARTUPS MAPPED IN THIS INDEX

\$13.47M

COMBINED MRR ANALYZED